RIOT LESSON 6: FACING OUR FEARS

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn strategies for facing fears. • Know how and when to use calming (arousal reduction) techniques to lower the fear response.	**Students will be able to:** • Demonstrate some arousal reduction techniques. • Complete an exposure ladder.

EXERCISE 1 FEARS

What are some common fears that some people have?

EXERCISE 2 RILEY'S 'HAVE A GO' LADDER

Riley would like to improve his social skills. Put his ladder in order, from the step he fears least to the step he fears most. Number them 1 to 5.

	Approach a classmate during break and ask if he can join in their game.
	Ask a classmate a quick question (e.g. 'Is the Maths quiz this Friday?').
	Make a comment to a classmate (e.g. 'Have a good weekend.').
	Make eye contact and say 'Hi' to one person he knows every day.
	Practise saying 'Hi! How are you?' with a friend.

EXERCISE 3 MY 'HAVE A GO' LADDER

Create your own 'Have a go' ladder for a fear or a problem you would like to deal with. If you can't think of one, try one of these: Noah is too nervous to give a talk in front of the class. Evie is so afraid of bees, she won't do sport on the oval. Claudia hates eating in front of people, so she usually eats nothing at school.

Goal:

Step 1 (least scary), and fear rating out of 10

Step 2, and fear rating

Step 3, and fear rating

Step 4 (most scary), and fear rating

EXERCISE 4 FACING FEARS

What are some short-term (say, over the next 6 months) consequences of not facing my fears?

What are some long-term (the rest of my life) benefits of facing my fears?